

CASE ID: 200709710305

EPISODE NAME: Dalai Lama Visits Austria 2007

2007/09/20 - 2008/10/24

Sender: China (710)

Target: Austria (305)

Issue: Terminate Support of Non-State Actors (10)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9) (4)

Narrative:

On 2007/09/20, the Austrian Chancellor Alfred Gusenbauer saw the Dalai Lama in his office for a “private” meeting,¹ drawing protest from the Chinese embassy in Vienna.² The meeting between Gusenbauer and the Dalai Lama took place in the Chancellery and lasted around 45 minutes.³ They discussed the situation in Tibet, as well as violence and terrorism globally.⁴

China never formally announced sanctions against Austria after the meeting. However, China reportedly ignored Austrian attempts at day-to-day diplomacy for several months after the visit.⁵

The episode ended on 2008/10/24 when Gusenbauer traveled to China on a state visit.⁶

¹ Fox, John and Godement, Francois. “A Power Audit of EU-China Relations.” *European Council on Foreign Relations*, April 2009. https://www.files.ethz.ch/isn/99125/EU_China_PowerAudit.pdf.

² “Austrian Chancellor Meets with Dalai Lama.” *VOA*, <https://www.voatibetan.com/a/a-28-2007-09-21-voa3-90298227/1272344.html>.

³ *Ibid*

⁴ *Ibid*

⁵ DS. “Gusenbauer at Wen: China respects Vienna's dialogue with exiled Tibetans.” *DerStandard*, 24 Oct. 2008. <https://www.derstandard.at/story/1224776240435/gusenbauer-bei-wen-china-respektiert-wiens-dialog-mit-exil-tibete>

⁶ *Ibid*.